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CUSTOMER POLICY · OX-CUS-004

Customs Clearance & Documentation Policy

Required documents, advance filing deadlines, brokerage services and responsibilities

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Effective date	2026-04-01	**Next review**	2027-04-01
Policy owner	Joris van der Velde, Managing Director - Europe (Global Customs Process Owner)	**Approved by**	Margaret Osei-Bonsu, Chief Compliance & Legal Officer
Applies to	Shippers, consignees and forwarders using OceanX ocean or customs brokerage services	**Classification**	Public

1. Principle

The **shipper and the consignee** are responsible for accurate customs declarations, correct classification (HS codes), valuation, origin and payment of duties and taxes. OceanX, as carrier, must submit advance cargo information to customs authorities using the data the shipper provides. Inaccurate or late data can lead to holds, fines, no-load orders or seizure. These costs are charged to the cargo interests.

2. Documents required for every shipment

- Commercial invoice (seller, buyer, Incoterms 2020 rule, currency, unit price, total value)
- Packing list (packages, gross and net weight, dimensions, marks and numbers)
- Shipping instructions (SI) submitted through OX Navigator
- Verified Gross Mass (VGM) under SOLAS Chapter VI, Regulation 2
- Certificate of origin, where preferential duty is claimed
- Licences or permits for controlled goods (dual-use, CITES, agricultural, pharmaceuticals)
- Dangerous Goods Declaration and Container Packing Certificate for IMDG cargo (OX-CUS-006)

3. Advance filing deadlines

Destination / route	Filing	Deadline	Filed by
USA	AMS / 24-Hour Rule	24 h before loading at foreign port	Carrier (and NVOCC for house B/Ls)
USA	ISF "10+2"	24 h before loading	Importer (10), carrier (2)
Canada	ACI eManifest	24 h before loading	Carrier
European Union	ICS2 Release 3 ENS	24 h before loading (deep sea)	Carrier + house-level filers
China	China Advance Manifest	24 h before loading	Carrier; consignee and shipper must include USCC/AEO code
India	IGM / Advance Arrival Manifest	Before vessel arrival (ICEGATE)	Carrier / shipping line agent
Singapore	TradeNet declaration	Before cargo release (import) or loading (export)	Declaring agent
Japan	AFR	24 h before loading	Carrier / NVOCC

OceanX SI cut-off is 48 hours before vessel ETD for all US, Canada, EU and China-bound cargo. Late SIs incur a **USD 75 late-documentation fee** and may cause the container to be rolled.

4. Cargo description rules

- Descriptions must be precise. "Freight of all kinds", "general cargo", "consolidated" and "said to contain" without detail are rejected.
- At least a 6-digit HS code is required for all destinations; 8 digits are required for China and India, and 10 digits are recommended for the EU.
- Weights must match the VGM to within 5%.

5. Customs brokerage services (optional)

OceanX offers licensed customs brokerage in the USA (licensed customs broker), the EU (direct and indirect representation), India (CHA licence), Singapore (declaring agent) and China (through a licensed partner).

Service	Fee (indicative)
Import entry, single line	USD 125 / EUR 110 / INR 6,500 / SGD 85
Each additional HS line	USD 6
ISF filing (USA)	USD 35
Bond (USA, single transaction)	Minimum USD 75
Customs examination coordination	USD 150 + terminal costs
Duty and tax advance (disbursement)	2% of amount, min USD 25

6. Incoterms and responsibility for duties

OceanX follows the Incoterms 2020 rule stated on the commercial invoice to determine who pays origin and destination charges. If it is unclear, the **consignee** is billed for destination charges and the **shipper** for origin charges.

Incoterm	Export clearance	Import clearance & duties
EXW	Buyer	Buyer
FCA / FOB	Seller	Buyer
CFR / CIF / CPT / CIP	Seller	Buyer
DAP / DPU	Seller	Buyer
DDP	Seller	**Seller**

7. Holds, examinations and penalties

- Customs holds and examinations are notified through OX Navigator and by email within 2 hours of OceanX becoming aware of them.
- Examination, devanning, storage and demurrage costs during a hold are charged to the cargo interests.
- Fines imposed on OceanX for inaccurate shipper data (e.g. a US CBP liquidated damages claim or an EU ICS2 penalty) are recharged at cost, plus a USD 250 administration fee.

8. Sanctions and export controls

OceanX will not carry cargo that would breach UN, US, EU, UK, Singapore or Chinese sanctions or export controls. We screen all parties and selected HS codes. Bookings may be held or cancelled without liability if screening identifies a risk.

9. Record keeping

Customs documents are kept for at least 5 years (USA: 5 years under 19 CFR 163; EU: 3 - 10 years by member state; India: 5 years; China: 3 years; Singapore: 5 years).

10. Contacts

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